

Species: PURPLE FINCH

Carpodacus purpureus

(Vernacular Name)

(Scientific Name-use binomial)

Date(s): January 2, 1977

Time Bird Seen: 8:30 am to 8:40 am

Locality: Colorado Springs

Nearest Town: Colorado Springs

County: El Paso

Other observers who independently identified this bird:

NAME	ADDRESS	TELEPHONE
<u>Chris Knight</u>	<u>2110 North Dr. Pueblo Colo 81007</u>	<u>545-9311</u>
<u>Carolyn P. Griffiths</u>	<u>1717 Morrison Pueblo Colo</u>	<u>561-2258</u>

Optical Equipment: 7x35 binoculars

If photographed, type of equipment used:

Light Conditions:

Distance from bird (how measured): estimated 15 feet to 50 feet

Number of Birds Seen: one Sex: ? Plumage: Female or immature

Describe the bird's overall behavior and demeanor:

a heavy striped finch with cone shaped beak in flock of Cassin's and house finch feeding on a brushy slope

Describe in great detail the bird's size, overall shape, plumage and color-pattern.

Include details on shape of bill, wings and tail. Give particular emphasis to the marks you used to identify the bird. Reference to its resemblance in field guide descriptions is not enough. Describe what you actually saw in the field:

I carefully observed 3 distinct field marks: heavy coned shaped beak unlike the thinner beaks of nearby Cassin's finches. Very uniform heavy side and belly stripes and the wide light eye stripe with dark cheek patch so distinct of Purple finches unlike thinner and less uniform stripes of female plumage Cassin's Finches.

I got close enough several times to see very clear unmarked under tail coverts unlike thin stripe (dark) on under tail coverts of Cassin's finches.

(OVER)

Describe the bird's song or call, if heard, including method of delivery, i.e., from perch, in flight, etc:

No song or call distinguished

Describe the habitat in which you observed this bird:

Heavy brushy fairly steep hill side in south side of Colo Springs - one or two homes on top of ridge had bird feeders

How were similarly appearing species eliminated?

See notes on front page

Prior experience with this and similarly appearing species:

Have seen many. Many House finches to which I feel there is no need for direct comparison. I have seen several 100's or more Cassin's finches as well as having several in the hand. I have probably seen 20 or 30 Purple Finches in California and Colo. I have had one in the hand (female) as well as photographs. Books, illustrations and advice consulted and how did these influence this documentation? Have studied Van Remsen's notes - North American Field Guide - Golden Press - Paugh's "All the Birds of Eastern and Central North America."

This report was written from notes made during ___ after x observation; from memory ___

PRINT NAME: DAVE A. GRIFFITHS SIGNATURE: Dave Griffiths DATE: Mar 6, 1977
Street Address: 1717 Morrison Ave Town and State: Dueblo Colo ZIP: 81005

Return to: JACK REDDALL - 4450 South Alton Street, Englewood, Colorado 80110